

What a 300-seat meeting costs on Zoom, Teams, Meet — and on BeeHive

Only the tiers that reach BeeHive's target of 300 attendees per session are shown — Zoom Business, Microsoft Teams at enterprise level, Google Workspace Business Plus; smaller tiers appear as a footnote where a vendor sells one. BeeHive is shown twice: as it runs today on free infrastructure (the "stub"), and after the plan upgrades the capacity audit calls for.

prices ex VAT · annual billing USD 1 = R16.25 · EUR 1 = R18.76 (mid-Sep 2026) BeeHive 1.0.304 · staging 16 Sep 2026

MONTHLY COST · ONE RECURRING 300-ATTENDEE SESSION · 10 LICENSED HOSTS

Zoom Workplace Business · 300 participants R3 482 /mo 10 × R348.17. Listed in Rand by Zoom SA.	Microsoft Teams Teams Enterprise · 1 000 participants R1 389 /mo 10 × \$8.55 standalone Teams. With Microsoft 365 E3 (Office, Windows, Intune): 10 × \$39 = R6 338.	Google Meet Workspace Business Plus · 500 participants R3 958 /mo 10 × €21.10. Business Standard stops at 150, so Plus is the first tier that fits.	BeeHive — stub (today) Supabase Free + LiveKit Build + Render Free R0 /mo But 300 cannot join: LiveKit Build caps at 100 concurrent connections and Supabase Free at 200 realtime connections. Practical ceiling ~50–100.	BeeHive — upgraded Supabase Pro + LiveKit Ship + Render Starter R1 333 /mo \$25 + \$50 + \$7 = \$82 flat, for any number of hosts. Includes ≈ 4 such sessions of connection-minutes; each extra 300 × 2 h session ≈ R290.
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Side by side

	Zoom Workplace Business	Microsoft Teams Teams Enterprise · Microsoft 365 E3	Google Meet Workspace Business Plus	BeeHive · stub free infrastructure, v1.0.304	BeeHive · upgraded Supabase Pro · LiveKit Ship · Render Starter
PRICE					
Per licensed host / month	R348.17 Zoom SA list price, ex VAT	R139 · R634 \$8.55 Teams Enterprise · \$39.00 M365 E3	R396 €21.10, billed in EUR	R0 no per-seat licence	R0 no per-seat licence

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Platform / infrastructure	— included in licence	— included in licence	— included in licence	R0 Supabase Free · LiveKit Build · Render Free	R1 333 /mo \$25 Supabase Pro + \$50 LiveKit Ship + \$7 Render Starter
Usage beyond included	Large Meeting add-on from R949.99/mo (500)	None up to 1 000 interactive; view-only overflow to 10 000	None up to 500	5 000 connection-min then hard stop; 50 GB egress	150 000 connection-min incl., then R0.008/min; 250 GB egress incl., then R1.95/GB
Pricing model	Per host, annual	Per user, annual; unlimited users	Per user, annual (EUR)	Flat infrastructure, no seats	Flat infrastructure, no seats
CAPACITY					
Participants per meeting	300 Pro tier: 100	1 000 Business tiers: 300	500 Starter 100 · Standard 150	~50-100 LiveKit Build: 100 concurrent connections; Supabase Free: 200 realtime connections	300 audience mode LiveKit Ship: 1 000 concurrent; Supabase Pro: 500 realtime
Live microphones at once	Unlimited (client-limited)	Unlimited (client-limited)	Unlimited (client-limited)	20 cap, host-moderated	20 cap, host-moderated
Cameras on screen	49 per page	49 per page	49 per page	25 per page · ≤ 8 recommended	25 per page · adaptive stream on
Meeting duration	30 h	30 h	24 h	No limit	No limit
Webinar / audience role	Add-on (Zoom Webinars)	YES Webinars and town halls included	Plus and up	YES "Large session" rooms: attendees join without publish rights; host promotes speakers	YES same, at 300
IN-MEETING FEATURES					
AI meeting notes	YES AI Companion, unlimited summaries	PARTIAL Transcripts and recap included; Copilot notes are a \$30 add-on	YES Gemini in Meet	YES AI Note Taker, on by default, one egress per room	YES
Noise suppression	YES	YES	YES Studio sound, Standard and up	YES Krisp (high on desktop) with native + expander fallback	YES

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Virtual backgrounds	YES	YES	YES	YES Blur + library + per-user uploads	YES
Waiting room & bulk admit	YES	YES	YES	YES Admit all, co-host delegation	YES
Cloud recording	YES 10 GB per licence	YES 10 GB (Teams Enterprise) · 1 TB+ (E3)	YES to Drive, 5 TB pooled	NO audio egress serves AI notes only	NO
Breakout rooms	YES	YES	YES	NO	NO
Phone dial-in	Add-on, R2 000/mo	Included (Audio Conferencing)	YES	NO	NO
Screen share, chat, reactions, hands	YES	YES	YES	YES laser pointer, direct chat, file share	YES
Desktop & mobile apps	YES	YES	YES	YES macOS (universal), web, mobile web	YES
OPERATIONS					
Admin / ops dashboard	YES	YES	YES	YES plan readiness, rooms, live mics	YES
Data residency	Multi-region storage (Business)	Microsoft cloud, SA region available	Google cloud	Postgres in eu-west-1; LiveKit global mesh	Same; Supabase Pro adds daily backups
Free-tier risk	—	—	—	HIGH Supabase Free pauses after 1 week idle; no backups	NONE

How the BeeHive upgraded figure is built

- **Supabase Pro** \$25/mo — 500 peak realtime connections, 8 GB database, backups, never pauses.
- **LiveKit Cloud Ship** \$50/mo — 1 000 concurrent connections, 150 000 connection-minutes, 250 GB downstream.
- **Render Starter** \$7/mo — always-on token backend (Free spins down and would add ~30 s to the first join).
- A 300×2 h session is 36 000 connection-minutes: about four per month inside the Ship allowance, then $\approx$ R290 each. Fifty such sessions would still be under R15 000/mo.

Reading the comparison honestly

- Vendors price per *host*; attendees are free everywhere. The strip assumes 10 hosts — at 9 hosts Teams Enterprise (R1 250) is still cheaper than BeeHive's flat R1 333; from 10 hosts up BeeHive is the cheapest option shown, and the gap widens with every host.
- BeeHive's ceiling of 20 live mics and 25 cameras is a deliberate audience-mode design; Zoom, Teams and Meet allow more but degrade on the client just the same. Teams Enterprise's 1 000 is the largest interactive cap of the four.
- Cloud recording and breakout rooms are the two features BeeHive does not have; neither is on the current roadmap.
- The stub column is what runs right now — the upgrade is a plan change plus two environment variables (`SUPABASE_PLAN` , `LIVEKIT_CLOUD_PLAN`), not code.

Sources, read 16 Sep 2026: zoom.us/pricing (ZAR, ex VAT, annual) · [microsoft.com/en-za Teams Enterprise](https://microsoft.com/en-za/Teams/Enterprise) (USD, annual) · workspace.google.com/pricing (EUR, annual, post-promo) · livekit.com/pricing · supabase.com/pricing · render.com/pricing.

Conversions at USD/ZAR 16.25 and EUR/ZAR 18.76 (mid-September 2026 spot); Rand figures for Teams, Meet and BeeHive infrastructure move with the exchange rate. BeeHive feature claims reflect build 1.0.304 on `staging` .